Wave has restricted further impoverishment, even if it has not always been successful in raising standards of living dramatically. It is a unique model of development where entire regions become residential sites and work is located at some distance.

The clusters and corridors of the wave shifted over time and also criss-crossed the world. At times, two unrelated clusters would accidentally cross each other. For instance, Ratnagiri's political star, Tilak, would serve out a term of imprisonment in Burma between 1908 and 1914 at the same time that the last King of Burma—Thibaw—was serving his life in exile in Ratnagiri. Today, both Tilak's house and Thibaw's palace are on exhibit in the quaint town of Ratnagiri. In other times, two corridors could unexpectedly meet through a marriage alliance. The Rai-Bachchan name signifies as much the union of two acting talents as the union of families linked with two distinct migratory corridors, one from coastal Karnataka and the other from east Uttar Pradesh, both meeting in Mumbai.

Such unexpected interconnections between clusters will continue in the 21st century as there is no terminal date in sight for the Great Indian Migration Wave. Declining birth rates could dampen population growth and weaken the impetus for outmigration.[100] Increasing female outmigration for work, either individually or with family, could potentially change the nature of mass migration in India. Yet, it is quite likely that the persistent zones, especially in the Gangetic belt, will continue to send out migrants for several more decades, maybe even a century, just as they have been doing so in the past. If the Bihari migrant went purab in the 19th century and *paschim* (west) in the 20th century, *dakshin* (south) may be a major calling in the 21st century as large wage differentials overcome previous linguistic barriers. The north–south corridor within India will be the latest addition to the Great Indian Migration Wave, already reflected in the fact that over 2 million north Indians work in Kerala today. This will imply the continuation of a life of separated existence between father and child, and husband and wife, for millions of families. The migration songs will continue. After all, in that eternal song, Shamshad Begum's lyrical words of longing were matched eloquently by the male voice that regretted leaving home and wife: